

Before You Reopen the Decision — completed example

This example is hypothetical. It uses the invented case from the sample review “I keep reopening decisions I already made,” filled in for the third reopen (after a weak candidate interview). No real person or company is represented.

1. The decision as it was made

What I decided. Hire a second logistics coordinator in-house rather than outsource fulfilment to a third-party provider.

When, and what has already been done because of it. Six weeks ago. CEO approved the headcount. Role posted four weeks ago. One interview held. Volume is being covered by the current coordinator plus overtime until the hire lands.

What I rejected, and why.

- Outsourcing: quoted cost was roughly 20% above the fully loaded cost of a second hire at our volume, and we would lose control of packaging and error handling, which is where our returns problem comes from.
- Doing nothing: the current coordinator has said overtime is not sustainable past about three months.

The reasons and assumptions it rested on (reconstructed; not written down at the time)

1. The role can be filled within about eight weeks at the budgeted salary.
2. Monthly volume stays within what two coordinators can handle, at current levels plus this year’s forecast growth.
3. Outsourcing pricing stays at or above the quote; the 20% gap holds.

What the original comparison did not consider. A hybrid: keep packaging and error handling in-house, outsource only carrier management. Could it change the choice? It keeps the control argument and might reduce how much of a second person we need. It does not remove the need for more in-house capacity, because packaging is where the hours go, so on its own it is unlikely to reverse the decision. It could change the shape of the role. That is enough to warrant one afternoon of pricing before I raise the salary band; it is not enough to reopen the whole comparison. Logged as an investigation item in Section 6.

2. What is prompting this reopen

What happened. First interview. The candidate had warehouse experience but no systems experience and was vague about carrier disputes. I would not hire them. Afterwards I found myself pricing outsourcing providers again.

What kind of thing it is. ☒ A fact I did not have. (One weak candidate is a small fact, but it is a fact, so it goes through Section 3.)

3. Does it change anything?

What it touches. ☒ A reason or assumption in Section 1: number 1. Nothing else on the list.

What I believed then, and what I believe now. Then: the role would fill within eight weeks at the budgeted salary. Now: four weeks in, one candidate, not hireable. Eight weeks is still possible but less comfortable. One interview is thin evidence about the pool; it is not evidence about the decision to hire. The budgeted salary may be low for someone with systems experience; I have not tested that.

With that one change, does the original decision still come out ahead? ☒ Yes, by less. The cost gap and the control argument are untouched. What has changed is the risk that the hire takes longer than the overtime bridge can cover. That is a timing risk, not a reason the decision was wrong.

4. What would justify reassessing

Conditions (written now, not at the time; provisional. Meeting one means a deliberate re-evaluation, not an automatic reversal.)

1. No credible offer made by week eight from posting, after raising the salary band once by up to 10%.
Eight weeks because the overtime bridge runs out at about three months and I want a month’s margin;
10% because that is what the budget can absorb without going back to the CEO.

2. An outsourcing quote at or below in-house fully loaded cost plus 5%, from a provider that will commit in writing to our packaging spec. The original decision rested on a roughly 20% price gap in favour of in-house plus control over packaging and error handling. If the gap narrows to 5% or less, the price reason is mostly gone and the decision would rest on control alone, which I have not put a number on. Crossing this line means valuing control against whatever saving remains, not reversing by default.
3. Volume forecast for the next two quarters revised up by more than about 30%, beyond what two coordinators can cover.

Is any of them met right now? ☒ No. Week four of eight. Band not yet raised. No new quote. No forecast change.

5. The cost of keeping this open

Time spent on this reopen so far: about three hours today, pricing providers I already priced. **Actions waiting on it:** deciding whether to widen the search; replying to the candidate.

What it costs other people. The current coordinator is on overtime and has asked twice where the hire stands. The CEO approved this six weeks ago and has not been told I am second-guessing it.

What it costs the next decision. I am already slower on the packaging vendor choice because I expect to reopen that too.

6. Verdict

- ☒ **Stands, with a condition added.** Assumption 1 is softer. Condition 1 in Section 4 now governs it.
- ☒ **Investigate one specific question, then close.** The question: does a hybrid (in-house packaging, outsourced carrier management) change the shape of the role? By: end of this week.

7. Next action and review point

The next concrete action, and when. Tomorrow: reply to the candidate. Price the hybrid option (one afternoon, by end of week); if it changes the role, modify the posting before raising the band. Otherwise raise the salary band by 8% and re-share the posting in two industry groups. Write the hiring bar (must-haves, assessment steps, what counts as good enough) so the next offer decision is “does this person meet the bar.” Tell the CEO the search is slower than planned and what the week-eight condition is.

The review point. Week eight from posting, four weeks from now, or the first candidate who meets the bar, whichever comes first. If condition 1 is met, get one fresh outsourcing quote and decide within a week. Until then, the decision is closed.

If the urge returns before the review point, I will: write down what prompted it and run it through Section 3: does it touch a reason in Section 1, a factor the comparison left out, a changed priority, a new option, or an error in the original reasoning? If it touches none of these and no Section 4 condition is met, close it. If it touches one, reopen that point on purpose.

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